the belligerents. Being the main architect of the conference and the chief Allied negotiator, Curzon was afforded an international stage for his diplomatic talents.[95] After many months of wrangling, the Treaty of Lausanne was signed in July 1923, finally bringing to an end the years of conflict between the Allies and Turkey.[96]

One of the most important results of Lausanne for the Muslim population throughout southern Asia was the recognition of the sovereignty of the new Republic of Turkey. The Turks had resisted the Allies and the punishing terms of Sèvres and had emerged successful from their nationalist struggle – 'All over the country [sic – region], the South Asian Muslims celebrated this occasion with great joy.'[97] However, for Muslim onlookers, the victory was to prove bitter-sweet. After the Armistice of Mudanya in 1922, the Kemalist government entered Constantinople and rapidly regained control of the city's administration from the Allies. The republican Grand National Assembly under Kemal Ataturk were now de facto rulers of Turkey and thus the sultan, Mehmed VI, quietly left the country. On 1 November the Sultanate was abolished by the assembly, followed a few days later by the election of the ex-sultan's cousin, Abdul Mejid, as Caliph – a democratised Caliphate for the newly democratic Turkish Republic.[98] In one stroke, the new Turkish government had removed centuries of tradition.

It had also undermined the whole foundation of the Caliphate movement which argued that the Caliph was not just a spiritual leader but a temporal one too.[99] From November 1922, any power the Caliph/Sultan once held now rested with the Turkish Assembly. One would have thought that, given how vehemently the Caliphate movement had protested against any hint of interference with the Caliph by the Allies, the Kemal government's actions would have been met with outcry. Instead, on 4 December, Reading reported that most Indian Muslims appeared confused and some distrusted the newspaper reports on the decision.[100] They simply 'could not accept that the Turks, who appeared to be fighting for the elevation of the caliphate, were instrumental in destroying it'.[101] Some even hoped that the Turks were only trying to save the Caliph from the burden of ruling the country so that he would have more time to concentrate on Muslim matters.[102] In December 1922, the Caliphate Committee expressed its acceptance of Turkey's actions and its continued support of the Kemalist